

TEACHING TIPS:

- Warm up the facial muscles ready to sing using exaggerated 'chewing' and 'munching' actions.
- Notice how the melody moves mainly by leaps, but then descends by steps (a **scale**) in bars 7 and 11. Indicating these intervals in the air with your hand flat in front of you will help your singers to pitch the intervals correctly.
- Try getting the children to raise their eyebrows (or caterpillars!) to help get their voices up to the high Cs in bars 5 and 9.
- Invent some actions for each verse to help them remember the different words, but don't make them too complicated, or they may forget to sing!

WHAT YOU NEED

Pitched and unpitched percussion instruments

BRIGHT IDEA!

What time of year is it? Is the weather warm or cold? Think about how you can make warm sounds (wooden instruments played softly) or cold sounds (metallic instruments played more loudly)?

STEP IT UP!

Try varying the dynamics to create contrast between the different verses of the song. Play '**guess the dynamic**' with one group of children performing either very softly (**pp**), softly (**p**), moderately loudly (**mf**) and very loudly (**ff**) – without shouting or straining their voices!). Can the other group guess the dynamic?

RHYTHM

Pulse – the beat, or steady heartbeat of the music

PITCH

Scale – an arrangement of notes in ascending or descending order of pitch

TIMBRE

The character or quality of a musical sound

Tone colour of instruments: low/high; soft/hard; metallic/wooden/stringed/wind

DYNAMICS

Volume

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES
4 - 7 

This song has a strong four-beats-in-a-bar **pulse**. Talk about what a pulse is (like a heartbeat or a ticking clock). To help the class to 'feel' the pulse, see if they can march on the spot or around the classroom in time to the music. Can they now 'creep and crawl', still keeping to the beat?

Try adding some simple unpitched percussion, e.g. guiros and woodblocks, to emphasize the pulse. They could play on all four beats of the bar, or as a challenge, just beats two and four, e.g. sh tap sh tap. What is the song about? Listen carefully to the words. Is there a story? Listen carefully to the backing track and see if you can pick out the different instruments and sounds that might relate to this – which sounds represent the caterpillar, and which the butterfly? Think about other sounds that you might hear in a garden, e.g. the wind in the trees, bees buzzing, birds singing etc. How might you reflect those sounds with instruments from your classroom instrument box?

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To begin to internalize pitch and pulse.
To begin to recognize a range of timbres.
To explore how different timbres can be used to create sound effects and imagery.